

ECO-ROCK ON THE BLOCK!!

Lab Grown Diamonds Sparking the Atmanirbhar Bharat Dream



Mrs. Pooja Sheth Madhavan
MD & Founder of Limelight
Lab Grown Diamonds Ltd.

Lab grown diamonds are becoming increasingly popular worldwide as they are not only real but also friendly on the pocket and to the environment. With the rising popularity of lab grown diamond across the world and India being the world's largest producer of Type IIa CVD diamonds - India once again is regaining its claim to fame of being the world's leading producer of the finest quality diamonds.

Lab grown diamonds (LGD) are exactly the same as mined diamonds but just grown in labs instead of growing below the earth. Just like the concept of test-tube babies and naturally born babies where the process is different but the output is exactly the same, LGDs are 100% real diamonds that are grown by exactly replicating the diamond creation process which occurs below the surface of the earth. As a result, LGDs have the same chemical, thermal, optical and physical characteristics as a mined diamond.

There are two types of lab-grown diamonds--CVD and HPHT. India

particularly specialises and leads in the chemical vapour deposition (CVD) technology that is certified as Type IIa - the purest type of diamonds, which is a rarity to find even in mined diamonds.

This rising demand has translated into rapid growth in export collections for India. In FY 2022, lab grown diamond exports nearly doubled to INR 9,764 Crores, compared to INR 5,175 Crores last year. Moreover, of the roughly 8,000 diamond polishing units in India, over 20-25% have begun polishing of lab grown diamonds and 15% polish only lab-grown diamonds exclusively.

An export oriented and import substitute product, lab grown diamonds are sparking the real dream of Atmanirbhar Bharat. This hasn't gone unnoticed by the Indian government and has announced several programs and incentives to encourage and establish India as the leader and main hub of lab grown diamonds. 100% FDI in lab grown diamond sector through the automatic route, 100% exemption on electricity duty for a term of 5 years, concessions in power cost, interest cost and tax, R&D support to develop indigenous technologies for LGDs etc.

"India will now see an increased number of international players enter India to set up their own CVD growing and manufacturing centres and boost the exports of LGDs from India. This will lead to a reduction in cost of LGD production and thereby making LGDs more price competitive compared to other international markets including China" says Mrs. Pooja Sheth Madhavan, MD & Founder of Limelight Lab Grown Diamonds Ltd.

Interestingly, lab-grown diamonds have the highest demand from the millennials. And with the ever-increasing environmental threats and depletion of mines, consumers have been quite wary of purchasing diamonds. They now focus not only on aesthetics and rarity in their jewels, but they also seek assurance that they are sourced responsibly. These values have led to an increased demand for lab grown diamonds and it is only expected to grow.

Leading the lab grown diamond initiative in the consumer space is Limelight Lab Grown Diamonds, India's largest luxury brand offering sustainable lab grown diamond studded jewellery. With its flagship store in Mumbai and availability across 25 cities including Bangalore, Hyderabad, Chennai, Delhi, Ahmedabad, Surat, etc., the brand continues to penetrate strongly in the Indian jewellery market.

"India, in my view, not only carries the potential of establishing itself as the production hub for lab grown diamonds but also of emerging as the largest consumer base too. Awareness on lab grown diamonds is spreading fast in India. Consumers are now more educated on these diamonds. The unique & independent personality of lab grown diamonds as a sustainable & environmentally friendly yet affordable gemstone is extremely well accepted in the millennial consumers and is increasingly reflecting in the sales of lab grown diamond studded jewellery across India." says Mrs. Pooja Sheth Madhavan, MD & Founder of Limelight Lab Grown Diamonds.